LA CUCINA ITALIANA - SEMPLICE ITALIAN KITCHEN | PASTA, RISOTTO & GNOCCHI

Authentic Ligurian Pesto Pasta with Potatoes and Green Beans (Trenette al Pesto)

Make authentic Ligurian Pesto Pasta with Potatoes and Green Beans (Trenette al Pesto) in one pot! Learn the Genoese secret for bright emerald pesto (+ free PDF).

Prep: 15 mins | Cook: 12 mins | Total: 27 mins | Yield: 4 servings | Calories: 540 kcal

INGREDIENTS CHECKLIST

[ ] 400g (14 oz) Trenette, Trofie, or Linguine Pasta
[ ] 250g (2 medium) Yukon Gold Potatoes (peeled and cut into 1.5cm cubes)
[ ] 200g (7 oz) Fresh Tender Green Beans (Haricots Verts) (trimmed and halved)
[ ] 70g (3 packed cups) Fresh Sweet Basil Leaves
[ ] 40g pine nuts, 1 small clove garlic Toasted Italian Pine Nuts & 1 Garlic Clove
[ ] 60g cheeses, 80ml olive oil Parmigiano-Reggiano, Pecorino & Extra Virgin Olive Oil

STEP-BY-STEP CULINARY INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Pulse or Pound the Emerald Pesto Genovese [6 mins]

In a mortar and pestle (or food processor using short pulses with an ice cube to prevent oxidation), blend basil leaves, pine nuts, garlic, and coarse sea salt. Fold in grated cheeses and extra virgin olive oil until creamy.

Step 2: Boil Potatoes & Pasta in One Single Pot [12 mins]

Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil. Drop in the cubed Yukon Gold potatoes first for 3 minutes, then add the trenette pasta and trimmed green beans to cook together for 9 minutes.

Step 3: Reserve Starchy Potato-Pasta Water [1 mins]

Before draining, scoop out 1/2 cup of the extra-starchy potato and pasta cooking water.

Step 4: Toss Off-Heat (Never Cook Fresh Pesto!)

Transfer the drained pasta, potatoes, and green beans into a warm serving bowl. Add the fresh basil pesto and 3 tablespoons of reserved starchy water, tossing gently until a silky green emulsion coats every strand.

CHEF'S PRO TIPS & STORAGE

* Boiling the diced potatoes in the same pot as the pasta releases extra potato starch into the water, which binds the basil pesto to the noodles like velvet.
* Never heat fresh basil pesto in a hot skillet on the stove-high heat turns bright green basil dark and bitter.